DLP Pilot Descriptive Results

June 22, 2026

Overview

The Dynamic Learning Program (DLP), developed by Dr. Christopher Bernido and Dr. Maria Victoria Carpio-Bernido, is an activity-based instructional model that places greater responsibility on students to read, write, and work through exercises before formal classroom discussion. DepEd has recognized DLP as an alternative delivery modality for contexts where conventional instruction is constrained by large class sizes, multiple shifts, or recurring class disruptions.

The pilot was designed to assess DLP across three implementation contexts: mainstream schools with large classes, schools operating multiple shifts, and schools affected by emergencies or repeated disruptions. One hundred schools were randomly assigned to each treatment context. Because procurement delays limited the planned rollout, the current data mainly describe schools that were able to proceed using their own resources. This brief summarizes the available monitoring and assessment data and should be read as descriptive evidence rather than an estimate of program impact.

Dataset Processing

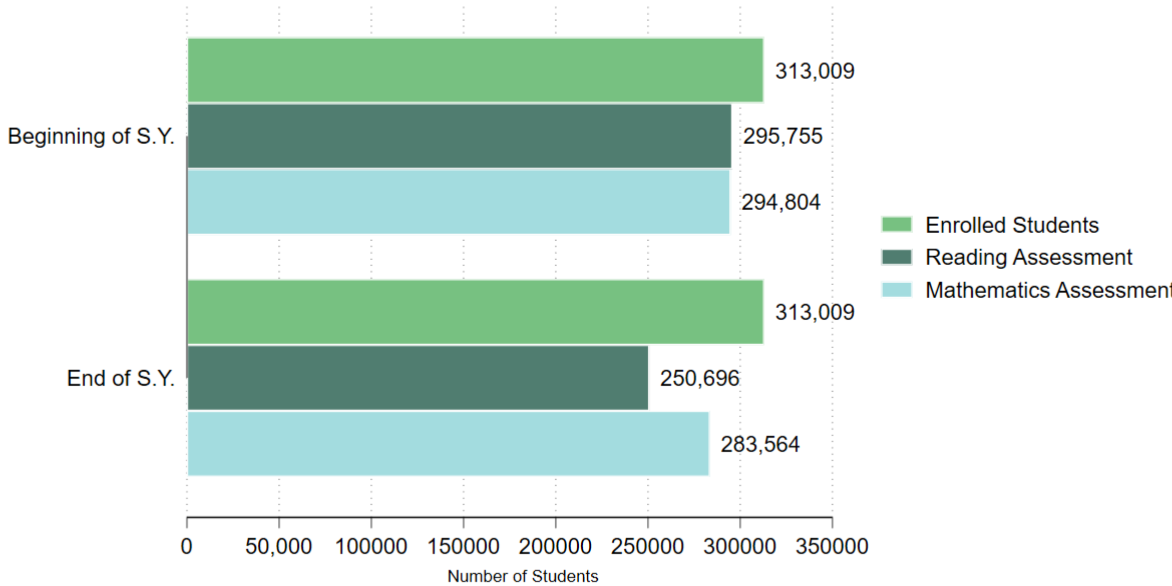
The monitoring file identifies 258 schools with final implementation status. Of these, 41 schools were recorded as having implemented a DLP model.

Figure 1 compares enrollment with available assessment records for mathematics and reading. The pilot schools enrolled 313,009 junior high school students. Phil-IRI coverage was 94 percent at the beginning of the school year and 80 percent at the end of the school year. RMA coverage was 94 percent at the beginning of the school year and 91 percent at the end of the school year.

Scope of Analysis

The analysis uses datasets provided by DepEd: baseline and endline rounds of the Rapid Mathematics Assessment, the Philippine Informal Reading Inventory, and monitoring data from the implementing unit. The monitoring data identify whether a school implemented DLP, but not the specific model used, the intensity or fidelity of implementation, or the timing of implementation during the school year.

Figure 1. Enrollment and Assessment Counts among DLP Schools



Reading Assessment is Philippine Informal Reading Inventory.
Mathematics Assessment is Rapid Mathematics Assessment.

Program Implementation

Among schools assigned to a treatment arm, 16 percent were recorded as implementing DLP. These figures reflect implementation ahead of the standard rollout and should be interpreted as early take-up under resource constraints. Implementation was highest among schools assigned to the emergency model and lowest among those assigned to the mainstream model.

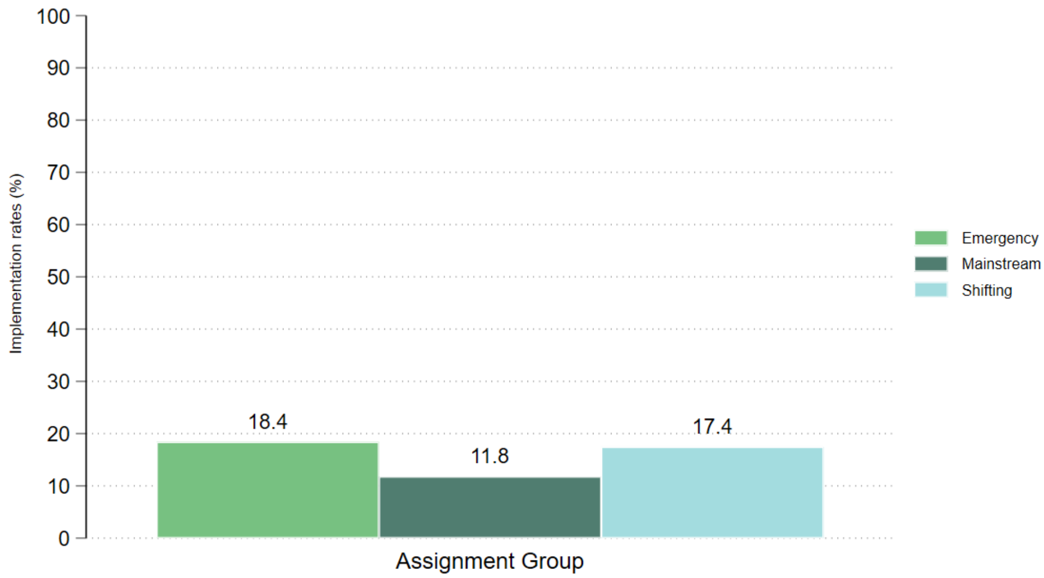
Table 1. Implementation rates, by treatment arm

Assignment group	Schools	Implementing schools	Implementation rate
Emergency	87	16	18.4%
Mainstream	85	10	11.8%
Shifting	86	15	17.4%

Note: The current dataset does not identify the DLP model actually implemented by each school. Compliance is therefore defined as implementation of any DLP model among schools assigned to a treatment arm.

Figure 2 shows implementation rates by treatment assignment. Schools assigned to the emergency and shifting arms had implementation rates of roughly 17 to 18 percent.

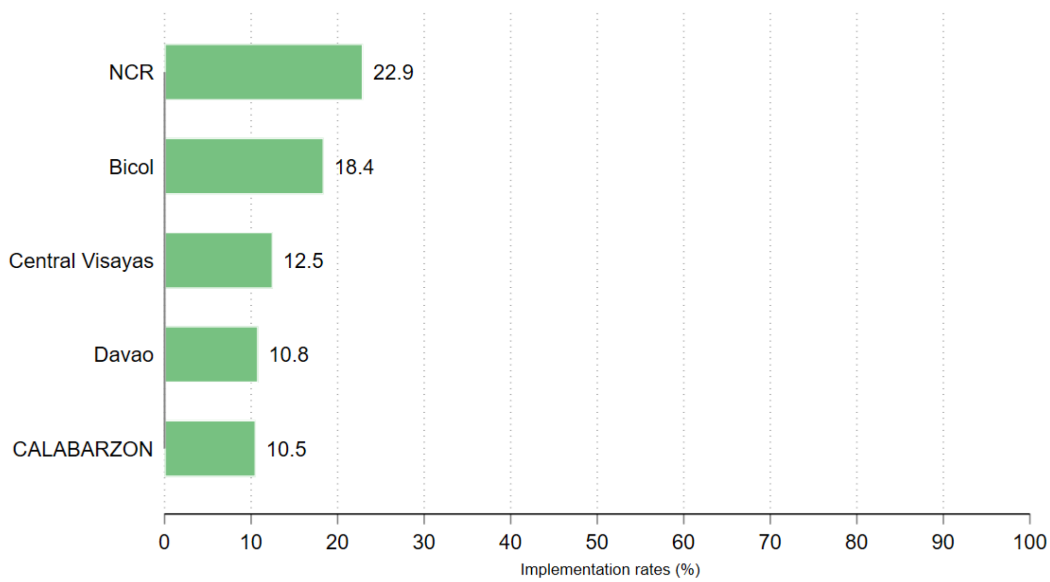
Figure 2. Implementation Rates by Treatment Assignment



Compliance is based on assignment group and implementation tag, regardless of DLP model.

Figure 3 shows regional variation in implementation. NCR and Bicol recorded the highest implementation rates, at 23 percent and 18 percent, respectively.

Figure 3. Implementation Rates by Region



Compliance follows assignment-to-treatment-status alignment.

Geographic Summaries

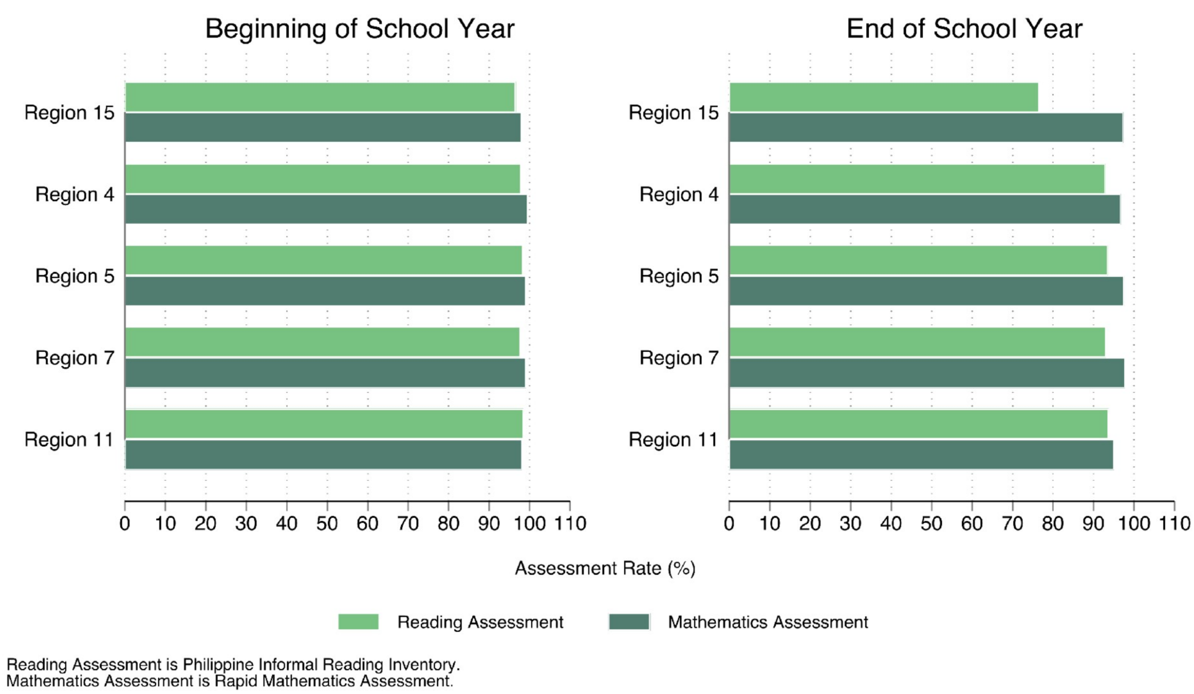
The randomized schools are distributed across five regions, with Region V accounting for the largest share of schools in the dataset. Assessment coverage is calculated using enrollment denominators from the assessment dashboard files.

Figure 4 indicates that assessment coverage remained relatively high across regions between the beginning and end of the school year.

Table 2. Implementation rates, by region

Region	Schools	Reading BoSY coverage	Reading EoSY coverage	Math BoSY coverage	Math EoSY coverage	Implementation Rate
Region 5	87	98.3%	93.5%	99.1%	97.6%	18.4%
Region 15	48	96.6%	76.6%	98.0%	97.4%	22.9%
Region 7	48	97.7%	93.0%	99.0%	97.7%	12.5%
Region 4	38	97.9%	92.9%	99.5%	96.7%	10.5%
Region 11	37	98.4%	93.6%	98.1%	95.0%	10.8%

Figure 4. BoSY and EoSY assessment coverage by region



Proficiency and Reading Categories (All Pilot Schools)

Student performance is summarized using the Rapid Mathematics Assessment for mathematics and Phil-IRI for reading. The figures compare beginning- and end-of-school-year assessment distributions among assessed students.

In mathematics, the beginning-of-year distribution was concentrated in the not proficient category. By endline, the share of assessed students in this category was substantially lower across Grades 7 to 10.

Table 3. Share of assessed students across Grade 7 to 10

Period	Group	Students	Share of assessed
BoSY	Not proficient	257,630	87.4%
EoSY	Not proficient	135,932	47.9%

For Phil-IRI, beginning-of-year data include both 2-level and 3-level reading categories. The end-of-year file does not contain the same fields, so the independent category is used as the closest available proxy for grade readiness in the comparison figures.

Figure 5 presents the mathematics proficiency distribution by grade and assessment round. Figure 6 presents the comparable reading pattern, using the available Phil-IRI categories and the endline proxy described above.

Table 4. Share of independent readers from BoSY to EoSY

Reading measure	Category used	Share of classified students
Beginning of School Year 2-Level	Independent	31.8%
Beginning of School Year 3-Level	Independent	25.5%
End of School Year Proxy	Independent	41.1%

Figure 5. Rapid Mathematics Assessment Proficiency by Grade Level

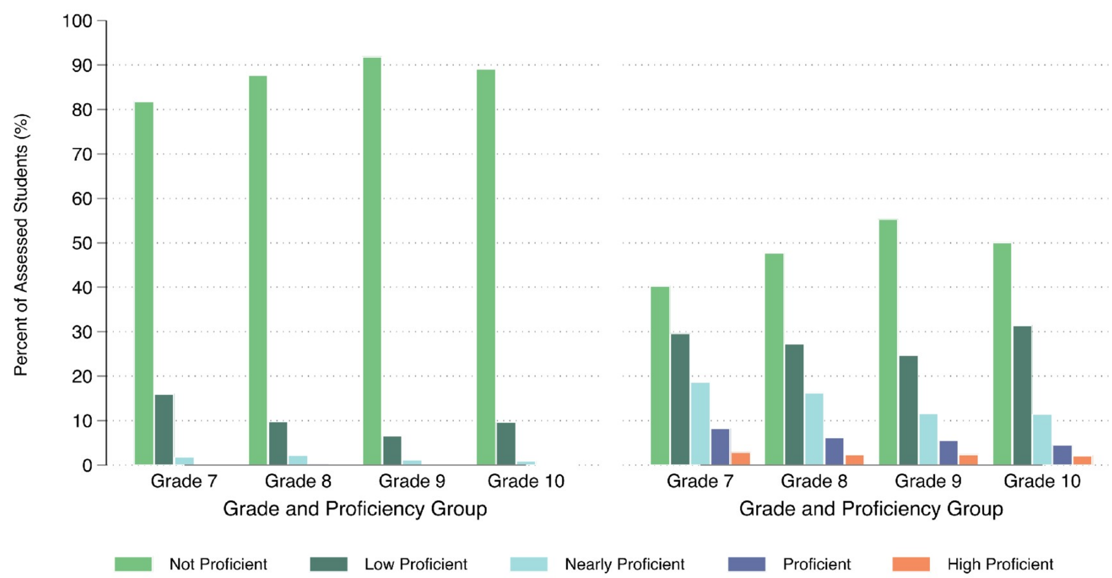
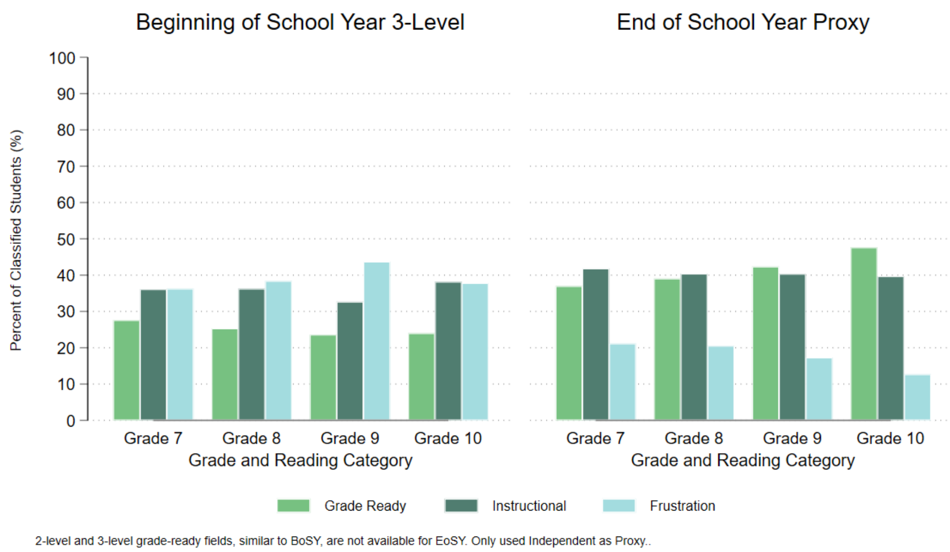


Figure 6. Philippine Informal Reading Inventory BoSY 3-Levels and EoSY Proxy by Grade Level

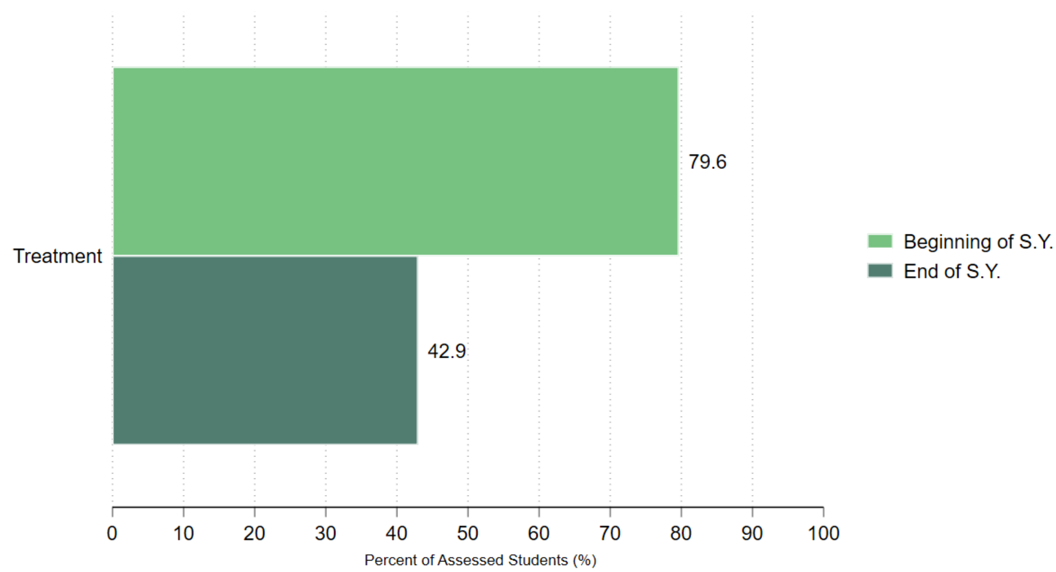


Subgroup Patterns (Treatment Schools)

For treatment schools, the brief also summarizes changes in mathematics and reading distributions between the beginning and end of the school year.

In mathematics, Figure 7 shows a lower share of assessed students classified as not proficient at endline among treatment schools.

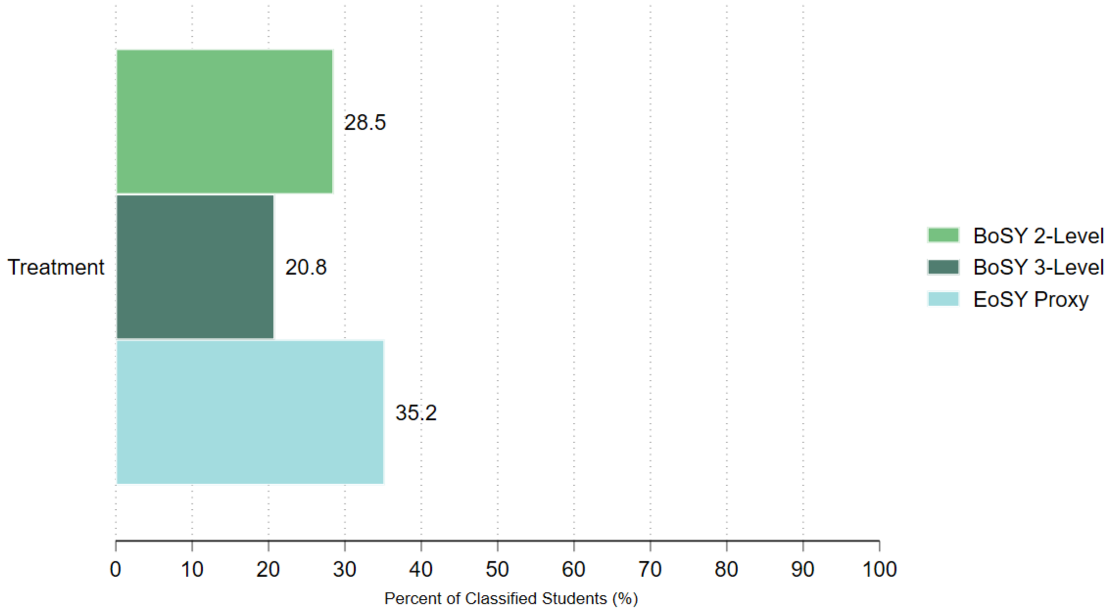
Figure 7. Rapid Math Assessment Shares in BoSY and EoSY by Treatment



Note: Figures report the percent share of assessed students.

For Phil-IRI, Figure 8 compares the available beginning-of-year independent reading categories with the endline independent-reader proxy. The pattern suggests a higher share of assessed students reading at or near grade-ready levels by the end of the school year among treatment schools.

Figure 8. Phil-IRI Grade Ready (Independent) Share



Note: Figures report the percent share of assessed students.

Preliminary Findings, Data Constraints, and Rollout Considerations

Data Constraints

- The analysis is limited to the DepEd datasets available at the time of reporting: reading and mathematics assessment files and program monitoring data.
- Implementation is measured as a binary indicator in the monitoring data. The file does not identify the DLP model implemented by each school, so model-specific compliance cannot be assessed.
- The monitoring data also do not capture implementation timing, dosage, fidelity, or classroom-level adherence to the model.

Interpretation of Descriptive Patterns

- The figures are descriptive. They characterize the available data and should not be interpreted as causal estimates of DLP effects.
- Treatment-control comparisons are not presented for performance outcomes at this stage, given the limited implementation captured in the monitoring file and the risk of misinterpreting simple differences as program impacts.
- Further analysis should be undertaken with the principal investigators once the monitoring data can better distinguish assignment, implementation, timing, and model fidelity.

Considerations for National Rollout

- Strengthen coordination across governance levels. Regular central office and field-level check-ins would help identify implementation bottlenecks early and give the research team clearer information on emerging risks.
- Account for procurement and materials timelines. Program materials should be available before rollout, including modules that can be printed or distributed throughout the school year.

- Improve monitoring tools for implementation fidelity. Monitoring systems should capture the DLP model used, timing of implementation, and basic fidelity indicators. Real-time monitoring would make the descriptive evidence more useful for program management.